

AI Words, Translated

20 words in plain human — from Kim at Moms AI Club

The basics

AI	The umbrella word for computers doing things that used to need a human brain. The "organic" of technology.
Generative AI	The kind that MAKES things — words, images, plans. Claude and ChatGPT are this kind.
Model	The actual brain. "New model" = brain upgrade, like a new phone.
LLM	The type of brain behind Claude and ChatGPT. Read half the internet to learn how people talk.
Chatbot / assistant	The friendly window you type into. The model is the brain; this is the face it wears.

Talking to it

Prompt	What you type. A text message to a very eager assistant.
Prompt engineering	Fancy words for asking better. "Shorter, warmer, try again" counts.
Token	The bite-size pieces AI reads. "Unbelievable" is about 3 bites. Limits are counted in these.
Context window	Its short-term memory. Marathon chats get forgetful — start fresh chats for new topics.
Usage limits	Your plan's daily allowance. Hitting it often = you're ready to upgrade.

Its quirks

Hallucination	Confident making-stuff-up. Not lying — guessing, with confidence. Double-check dates, prices, anything big.
Training data	Everything the brain read in school. Why it knows Shakespeare but not spirit week.
Machine learning	How it learned — millions of examples, no rulebook. Like kids learning sarcasm.
Bias	It picked up the internet's habits, good and bad. Your judgment stays in charge.

The buzzwords

Algorithm	A recipe a computer follows; also what picks your feed. Older than AI, not the same thing.
Multimodal	Handles photos, voice, and documents too. Snap the permission slip, ask what to do.
Agent	AI that DOES the task, not just answers. The word you'll hear everywhere this year.
Stack	Someone's list of go-to tools. Yours might just be Claude. That counts.

The dinner-party words

Deepfake	AI-faked video/audio of a real person. "Video proof" isn't automatic proof anymore — worth one honest chat with your kids.
AGI	The sci-fi milestone: AI as capable as a person at everything. Not what you're using today; mostly a debate topic.